

PocketBase with Dart

Open-Source Real-time Database
for Modern Applications

What is PocketBase?

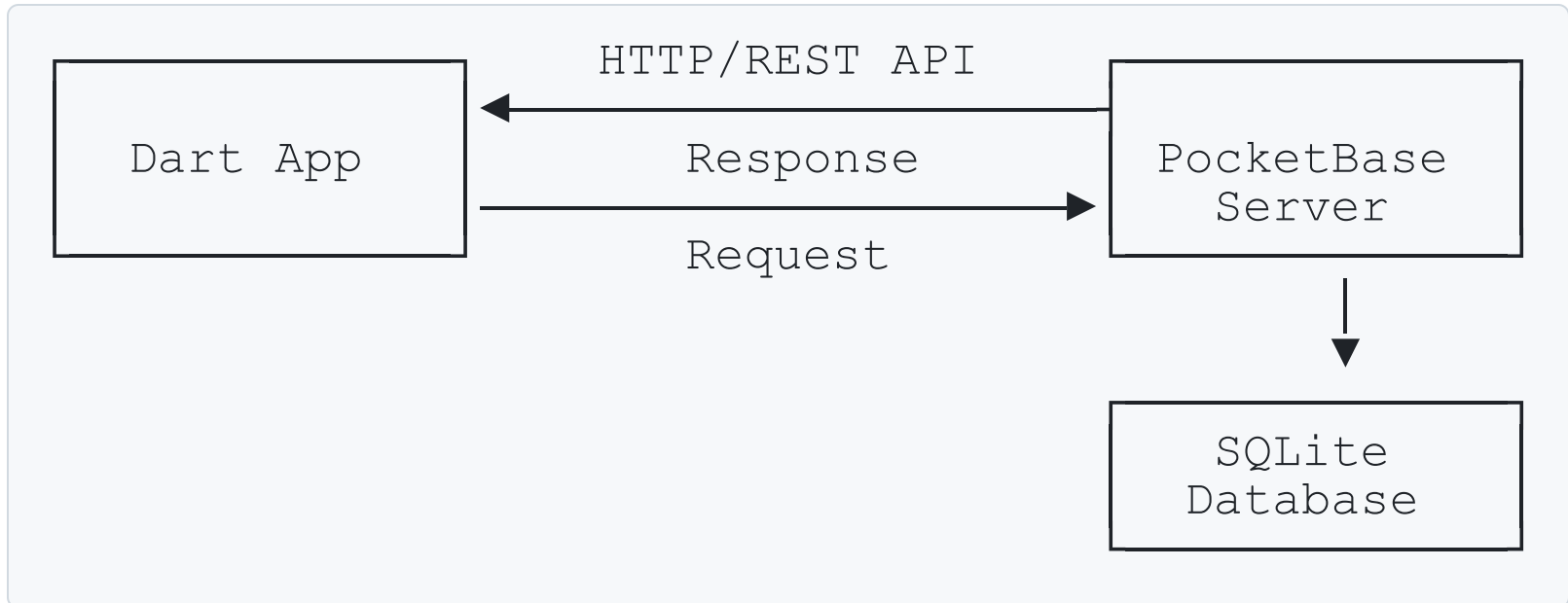
- **Open-source backend** in a single executable file written in Go
- **Real-time SQLite database** with REST API
- **Built-in authentication** and authorization
- **Perfect for rapid prototyping** and small to medium apps
- **Zero configuration** - runs immediately
- **Admin dashboard** included

PocketBase Features

- SQLite database with REST API
- Real-time subscriptions
- File storage
- Admin dashboard
- Email templates
- OAuth2 providers

Used by: Developers for startups, personal projects, educational apps

Architecture Overview



- Three-tier architecture: Client - Backend - Database
 - Client (Dart/Flutter)
 - Backend (Go executable PocketBase)
 - Database (Single file SQLite)

Project Setup

```
# pubspec.yaml
dependencies:
  # PocketBase client
  pocketbase: ^0.23.0

  # Utility packages
  uuid: ^4.5.1
  intl: ^0.20.2

dev_dependencies:
  lints: ^6.0.0
  test: ^1.21.0
```

- Use Pocketbase_Quick_Start_Guide

- Run `dart pub get` to get all the dependencies installed.
- Run `dart pub outdated` to find newer versions incompatible with dependency constraints.
- To update these dependencies, edit `pubspec.yaml`, or run `dart pub upgrade --major-versions`.

Code Skeleton

```
import 'package:pocketbase/pocketbase.dart';  
  
// Connect to PocketBase server  
final pb = PocketBase('http://127.0.0.1:8090');
```

- Initialize Client

Authentication

```
// Test authentication
await pb.collection('users').uthWithPassword(
  'user@example.com',
  'password'
);
print('✅ Authentication successful');
```

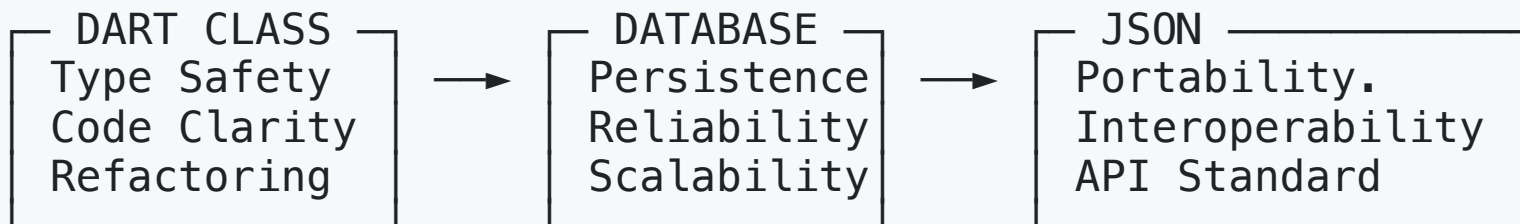
Test Connection

```
// Test health check
await pb.health.check();
print('✅ PocketBase server is running');
```

Data Model Overview

- A **data model** is essential for all software architecture and design.
- The student data model is defined as a **Dart class** to ensure strong typing and seamless integration with the application.

- This model should be **persisted in a database** for reliable data storage and retrieval.
- **JSON format** is used for API communication, enabling data exchange between the app and external services.



Data model: foobar

- When we design database, we should design how the information is represented in JSON, DATABASE, and Dart Class.
- This is our **data model**.
- Examples are in the `foobar/` directory.

```
foo: String  
bar: int
```

JSON

- We represent the data model in JSON as follows.

```
{ "foo": "val1", "bar": 323 }
```

- In Dart, this is represented as a `Map<String, dynamic>` datatype.

```
Map<String, dynamic> json = {  
  "foo": "val1", "bar": 323  
}
```

- We can have multiple JSON objects in a list.

```
[  
  { "foo": "val1", "bar": 123 },  
  { "foo": "val2", "bar": 223 },  
  { "foo": "val3", "bar": 323 }  
]
```

Pocketbase RecordModel

- RecordModel is the representation of information in Pocketbase.

```
RecordModel {  
  // Automatically generated Unique identifier  
  id: "abc123def456",  
  // Your actual data  
  data: {  
    "foo": "randomstring",  
    "bar": 42  
  },  
}
```

RecordModel and JSON

- We can directly access pocketbase collection reference.
- Using the reference, we can retrieve the RecordModel data.
- The data field of the RecordModel is the JSON data structure.

```
RecordService get _foobarRef =>
    _pb.collection('foobar');
final record = await _studentsRef.getOne(id);
final json = record.data;
```


Dart Class

```
class FooBar {  
  String foo;  
  int bar;  
  // constructor  
  FooBar({  
    required this.foo,  
    required this.bar,  
  });  
}
```

Service function for JSON conversion

```
factory FooBar.fromJson(Map<String, dynamic> json) {  
    return FooBar(  
        foo: json['foo'] as String,  
        bar: json['bar'] as int,  
    );  
}  
Map<String, dynamic> toJson() => {  
    'foo': foo,  
    'bar': bar,  
};
```

- The elements in the record RecordModel can be empty, so we use the `record.data['name'] as String? ?? ''` expression to set the default value.
- The expression is the same as the following code.

```
value = '';  
if (record.data['foo'] != null) {  
    value = record.data['foo'];  
}  
  
record.data['name'] as String? ?? ''
```

- So, we use the following to safely convert from JSON to the FooBar object.
- Remember that JSON is the same as record.data.

```
factory FooBar.fromJson(Map<String, dynamic> json) {  
  return FooBar(  
    foo: json['foo'] as String? ?? '',  
    bar: json['bar'] as int ?? 0,  
  );  
}
```

Service function for Object comparison

- It is the same as Java's `equals` .

```
@override
bool operator ==(Object other) {
    if (identical(this, other)) return true;
    return other is FooBar
        && other.foo == foo
        && other.bar == bar;
}

@override
int get hashCode => foo.hashCode ^ bar.hashCode;
```

Run foobar_json_test.dart

- Run `dart test`

```
pocketbase> dart test test/foobar/foobar_json_test.dart
00:00 +11: All tests passed!
```

- Or run `dart`

```
smcho@mac pocketbase> dart test test/foobar/foobar_json_test.dart
00:00 +0: FooBar Constructor Tests should create FooBar with required parameters
00:00 +1: FooBar Constructor Tests should create FooBar with different values
00:00 +2: FooBar JSON Serialization Tests should convert FooBar to JSON correctly
...
00:00 +9: FooBar Edge Cases should throw when JSON has wrong types
00:00 +10: FooBar Edge Cases should throw when JSON is missing required fields
00:00 +11: All tests passed!
```

Pocketbase Collection

- We need to create a collection to make a RecordModel.
- We created a collection using API.

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:8090/api/collections \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_ADMIN_TOKEN" \
-d '{"name": "students", "type": "base",
  "schema": [{"name": "name", "type": "text", "required": true,
    "options": {
      "min": 1,
      "max": 100
    }
  ]
}
```

Programmatic Collection Setup

- We can create the collection programmatically.

```
final collection = await pb.collections.create(body: {
  'name': 'foobar',
  'type': 'base',
  'fields': [
    {'name': 'foo', 'type': 'text', 'required': true},
    {'name': 'bar', 'type': 'number', 'required': true},
  ],
  'createRule':
    '@request.auth.id != ""', // Only authenticated users can create
  'updateRule':
    '@request.auth.id != ""', // Only authenticated users can update
  'deleteRule':
    '@request.auth.id != ""', // Only authenticated users can delete
  'listRule': '', // Anyone can list records
  'viewRule': '', // Anyone can view records
});
```


Why Do I Need Rules in PocketBase?

- Access rules control **who can access or change your data.**
- If you **skip them**, your API may be **completely locked down.**

What Are Rules?

Each collection can have:

Rule	Controls
<code>createRule</code>	Who can create new records
<code>updateRule</code>	Who can update existing records
<code>deleteRule</code>	Who can delete records
<code>listRule</code>	Who can list all records
<code>viewRule</code>	Who can view a single record

What Happens If You Skip Rules?

Rule	Default Behavior
<code>createRule</code>	✗ No one can create
<code>updateRule</code>	✗ No one can update
<code>deleteRule</code>	✗ No one can delete
<code>listRule</code>	✗ No one can list
<code>viewRule</code>	✗ No one can view

Result: Your collection is inaccessible!

Examples of FooBar

- Public Read, Authenticated Write

```
{  
  createRule: '@request.auth.id != ""',  
  updateRule: '@request.auth.id != ""',  
  deleteRule: '@request.auth.id != ""',  
  listRule: '',  
  viewRule: ''  
}
```

Real-world equivalent: Database table creation with permissions

Usage

```
// Example: Create a record with direct field access
final record =
    await pb.collection('foobar').create(
        body: {'foo': 'val1', 'bar': 323});

// Access fields directly
print('id value: ${record.data['id']}'); // Automatically assigned
print('foo value: ${record.data['foo']}'); // Output: val1
print('bar value: ${record.data['bar']}'); // Output: 323
```

```
RecordModel {
  data: {
    id: "abc123def456",
    "foo": "randomstring",
    "bar": 42
  },
}
```

The CRUD Pattern

Universal Database Operations

Operation	Purpose	HTTP Method	SQL Equivalent
Create	Add new data	POST	INSERT
Read	Retrieve data	GET	SELECT
Update	Modify existing	PUT/PATCH	UPDATE
Delete	Remove data	DELETE	DELETE

Key Insight: This pattern works with **any database**

- SQL: MySQL, PostgreSQL
- NoSQL: MongoDB, Firebase
- Same concepts, different implementation
- **Abstract thinking** for better software design

CREATE

- Add a new FooBar record to the database
 - Returns the created FooBar with its generated ID

```
Future<FooBar> create(FooBar foobar) async {  
  try {  
    // Convert FooBar object to JSON and send to PocketBase  
    final record = await _pb.collection(_collectionName).create(  
      body: foobar.toJson(),  
    );  
    // Convert the returned record back to FooBar object  
    return FooBar.fromJson(record.data);  
  } catch (e) {  
    throw Exception('Failed to create FooBar: $e');  
  }  
}
```


READ Operations

Fetching One Data from ID

```
Future<FooBar> getById(String id) async {  
  try {  
    // Fetch record from PocketBase using the ID  
    final record = await _pb.collection(_collectionName).getOne(id);  
  
    // Convert record data to FooBar object  
    return FooBar.fromJson(record.data);  
  } catch (e) {  
    throw Exception('Failed to get FooBar with ID $id: $e');  
  }  
}
```

Fetching All Data

```
Future<List<FooBar>> getAll() async {  
  try {  
    // Fetch all records from the collection  
    final resultList = await _pb.  
      collection(_collectionName)  
        .getFullList();  
  
    // Convert each record to FooBar object  
    // and return as list  
    return resultList.map((record) =>  
      FooBar.fromJson(record.data)).toList();  
  } catch (e) {  
    throw Exception('Failed to get all FooBar records: $e');  
  }  
}
```

Fetching Data with Pagination

```
Future<List<FooBar>> getRecord(
    [int page = 1, int perPage = 5]) async {
    try {
        // Get paginated list (ResultList wrapper object)
        final resultList = await _pb
            .collection(_collectionName)
            .getList(page: page, perPage: perPage);

        return resultList.items
            .map((record) => FooBar.fromJson(record.data))
            .toList();
    } catch (e) {
        throw Exception('Failed to get all FooBar records: $e');
    }
}
```

Read the next 5 pages

```
getRecord([int page = 5+1, int perPage = 5])
```

Pagination Benefits

- **Memory efficiency** - Don't load all data at once
- **Better user experience** - Faster loading
- **Scalability** - Works with millions of records

Search FooBar records with filtering

```
// Example usage:
//  searchByFoo("hello") returns
//  all records where foo contains "hello"
Future<List<FooBar>> searchByFoo(String searchTerm) async {
  try {
    // Use PocketBase filter syntax to search
    final resultList = await _pb.collection(_collectionName)
      .getFullList(
        filter: 'foo ~ "$searchTerm"', // ~ means "contains"
      );
    return resultList.map((record) =>
      FooBar.fromJson(record.data)).toList();
  } catch (e) {
    throw Exception('Failed to search FooBar records: $e');
  }
}
```

UPDATE Operations

Modifying Existing Records

```
Future<FooBar> update(String id, FooBar updatedFoobar) async {  
  try {  
    // Send updated data to PocketBase  
    final record = await _pb.collection(_collectionName).update(  
      id,  
      body: updatedFoobar.toJson(),  
    );  
  
    // Return the updated FooBar object  
    return FooBar.fromJson(record.data);  
  } catch (e) {  
    throw Exception('Failed to update FooBar with ID $id: $e');  
  }  
}
```

UPDATE Operations - Best Practices

1. Defensive Programming

```
// Always check if fields exist before updating
if (updatedFoobar.toJson().containsKey('foo')) {
    // Safe to access nested data
}
```

2. Partial Updates

```
// Only update specific fields, not entire record
var currentFooBar = currentFooBar.toJson();
var currentBar = currentFooBar['bar'];
updateData = {
  {'foo': 'P-$currentFoo', 'bar': currentBar},
};
// PocketBase merges with existing data
```


3. Error Handling

```
try {  
  final updated = await pb.collection('foobar').update(id, body: updateData);  
} catch (err) {  
  // Handle network errors, validation errors, etc.  
  print('Update failed: $err');  
}
```

DELETE Operations

1. Single Record Deletion

```
Future<bool> delete(String id) async {  
    try {  
        // Delete the record from PocketBase  
        await _pb.collection(_collectionName).delete(id);  
        return true;  
    } catch (e) {  
        throw Exception('Failed to delete FooBar with ID $id: $e');  
    }  
}
```

2. Batch Deletion with Pagination

```
Future<void> deleteAllRecords() async {  
    int page = 1;  
    const int perPage = 10;  
    int totalDeleted = 0;  
  
    while (true) {  
        final result = await pb.collection('records')  
            .getList(page: page, perPage: perPage);  
  
        if (result.items.isEmpty) break;  
  
        for (final item in result.items) {  
            await pb.collection('records').delete(item.id);  
            totalDeleted++;  
        }  
    }  
    print('Total records deleted: $totalDeleted');  
}
```

FooBar Utility

- We started with the Data model: `foobar.dart`.
- We provided the CRUD service: `foobar_crud.dart`.
- We created unittests for each module.

- The next step is to provide the utility service.
 - Read the source: `foobar/lib/foobar_utility.dart`
 - Read the tests:
`foobar/test/foobar_utility_test.dart`
 - Read the doc: `foobar/test/foobar_utility.md`